FLIPSIDE

> *"One mind. Two worlds. Only one can move at a time."*

Game Design 3A - AI-Assisted Game Jam Theme: Switch **Developer:** Gift Zowa **Student Number:** ST10443108 **Engine:** Unity 2022.3 LTS (URP) **Jam Duration:** 3 Days (March 2026)

Overview

FLIPSIDE is a 2D split-screen puzzle platformer built for the Game Design 3A Game Jam around the theme "Switch."

The screen is split permanently into two halves. The top half shows ARC in a bright, clean geometric world. The bottom half shows ECHO in the dark, mirrored version. Both worlds are always visible - but only one character is under your control at a time.

Press Tab to switch control between them. The inactive character freezes in place. Their half of the screen dims. The active half brightens - you always know who you are controlling.

Physical Switch objects are scattered through each level. When a character hits one, something changes in the other world - a platform appears, a hazard disappears, a gate opens. ARC and ECHO depend on each other to progress. Neither can finish alone.

Each character has their own countdown timer. The active character's timer drains fast; the inactive one drains slowly. If either hits zero, the level resets. Manage both timers while solving the puzzle - or run out of time.

Boost Orbs can be collected mid-level. Collecting one boosts the other character - rewarding planning over reflexive grabbing.

"Switch" is the action, the control mechanic, and the visual identity of the game - all at once.

How to Run

Option A - Play the Build (Recommended)

1. Download and extract `FLIPSIDE_Build.zip`
2. Open the extracted folder
3. Run `FLIPSIDE.exe`
4. No installation required

Option B - Open in Unity

1. Clone or download this repository
2. Open Unity Hub, click Add Project, select the project root folder
3. Make sure you are using **Unity 2022.3 LTS**
4. Install required packages via Package Manager (see `requirements.txt`)
5. Open `Assets/Scenes/MainMenu.unity` and press Play

Controls

Action	Key
Move	A / D or Left / Right Arrow
Jump	Space
Switch Character	Tab

How to Play

- You start each level controlling ARC (top half, bright world)
- Press **Tab** at any time to swap to ECHO (bottom half, dark world)
- The inactive character freezes exactly where they are
- Look for glowing **Switch objects** - activating them changes something in the other world
- Watch both timers - the active character's drains fast, the inactive one slowly
- Collect **Boost Orbs** to give the other character a speed or jump boost
- Get both ARC and ECHO to their exit doors before either timer runs out
- When one character reaches their exit, control moves to the other automatically

---

Credits

Developer: Gift Zowa (ST10443108)

AI Tools Used

Tool	Purpose	Contribution
Cursor	Code generation & refactoring	All C# scripts generated and debugged with AI assistance. Scripts reviewed, tested, and manually adjusted by developer.
Leonardo AI	2D tile art & character sprites	All tile sets, character sprites, Switch/Boost Orb sprites, backgrounds, and UI elements generated via AI prompts at 512x512.
Soundraw	Background music	Ambient tracks for ARC's world and ECHO's world generated via AI.
ElevenLabs / GizAI	Sound effects	Switch activation, Tab switch sound, death sound, level complete chime generated via AI.
Claude (Anthropic)	Writing & documentation	Game concept development, all markdown documentation, script architecture guidance, and reflection writing supported with AI assistance.

All AI-generated assets were reviewed, selected, and deliberately integrated by the developer. Nothing was used unmodified without a conscious creative decision.

AI Ethics Statement

This project used AI tools heavily across code, art, audio, and documentation, in full compliance with Game Design 3A assessment requirements.

Originality: All AI outputs were evaluated and curated before use. The game concept, relay mechanic design, timer system, boost orb mechanic, level design, and overall creative direction came from me. AI was used as a collaborator and time-saver, not as a substitute for design thinking.

Transparency: All AI contributions are documented in this readme and in `plan.md`. Every Cursor prompt is logged in `refinements-changes.md` with an honest assessment of the output quality and what I changed manually. All AI-generated art assets are listed in `requirements.txt` with their source tool, and generation prompts are logged in `refinements-changes.md`.

Fair Use: All AI tools used generate original outputs and do not reproduce copyrighted material. No third-party copyrighted assets were used without a compatible licence.

Reflection: Honest reflection on the benefits, limitations, and ethical considerations of working with AI is included at the end of `plan.md`.

Project Structure

```
FLIPSIDE/
+-- Assets/
|   +-- Scenes/
|   |   +-- MainMenu.unity
|   |   +-- Level_01.unity
|   |   +-- Level_02.unity
|   |   +-- Level_03.unity
|   |   +-- Level_04.unity
|   |   +-- Level_05.unity
|   |   +-- Level_06.unity
|   |   +-- Level_07.unity
|   +-- Scripts/
|   |   +-- PlayerController.cs
|   |   +-- EchoController.cs
|   |   +-- CharacterSwitcher.cs
|   |   +-- WorldSwitch.cs
|   |   +-- SwitchableObject.cs
|   |   +-- SplitScreenSetup.cs
|   |   +-- CameraFollow.cs
|   |   +-- HazardTile.cs
|   |   +-- MovingHazard.cs
|   |   +-- BoostOrb.cs
|   |   +-- ExitDoor.cs
|   |   +-- LevelManager.cs
|   |   +-- LevelTimer.cs
|   |   +-- UIManager.cs
|   |   +-- LevelCompleteUI.cs
|   |   +-- MainMenu.cs
|   +-- Sprites/
|   |   +-- ARC/
|   |   +-- ECHO/
|   +-- Audio/
|   |   +-- Music/
|   |   +-- SFX/
|   +-- Tilemaps/
|   |   +-- ARC_Palette
|   |   +-- ECHO_Palette
```

```
|   +-- UI/
|       +-- Fonts/
+-- Packages/
+-- ProjectSettings/
+-- high-concept.md
+-- plan.md
+-- readme.md
+-- requirements.txt
+-- refinements-changes.md
```

References

Anthropic (2024) *Claude* [Large language model]. Available at: https://claude.ai (Accessed: March 2026).

Cursor (2024) *Cursor AI-assisted IDE* [Software]. Available at: https://cursor.sh (Accessed: March 2026).

ElevenLabs (2024) *ElevenLabs AI audio generation* [Software]. Available at: https://elevenlabs.io (Accessed: March 2026).

Google Fonts (2024) *Orbitron* [Typeface]. Available at: https://fonts.google.com/specimen/Orbitron (Accessed: March 2026).

Leonardo AI (2024) *Leonardo.Ai* [Image generation platform]. Available at: https://leonardo.ai (Accessed: March 2026).

Soundraw (2024) *Soundraw AI music generator* [Software]. Available at: https://soundraw.io (Accessed: March 2026).

Unity Technologies (2022) *Unity 2022.3 LTS* [Game engine]. Available at: https://unity.com (Accessed: March 2026).